

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	P – Strategies to Empower People (STEP) Program
	Section No./Name	P-500-STEP Sanctions/Good Cause
	Document No./Name	P-540-STEP Sanction Periods
	Effective Date	January 1, 2021

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

Sanctions are to be used as a last resort when FITAP work-eligible families have not met the required expectations of the STEP Program.

II. PROCEDURES

When a work-eligible recipient fails to comply, without good cause, with STEP Program requirements as described in [P-520-STEP](#), the following STEP sanctions are applied:

- First occurrence (STEP Sanction Code, Occurrence 1) - FITAP case closure for minimum of one month. Once the STEP 1 sanction is imposed, the FITAP case cannot be recertified until one month of FITAP benefits is missed and the sanctioned recipient complies, has a good cause reason, or is granted Good Cause *** from** STEP participation.
- Second occurrence (STEP Sanction Code, Occurrence 2) - FITAP case closure for minimum of two months. Once the STEP 2 sanction is imposed, the FITAP case cannot be recertified until two months of FITAP benefits are missed and the sanctioned recipient complies, has a good cause reason, or is granted Good Cause **from** STEP participation.
- Third and subsequent occurrences (STEP Sanction Code, Occurrence 3) - FITAP case closure for minimum of three months. Once the STEP 3 sanction is imposed, the FITAP case cannot be recertified until three months of FITAP benefits are missed and the sanctioned recipient complies, has a good cause reason, or is granted Good Cause **from** STEP participation.

All STEP sanctions **and the client's failure to comply details** must be discussed with the **STEP Supervisor** and documented in **Person Notes** and in LITE using the ***Request a Sanction*** tab in the **Referrals module**.

The appropriate **Failure to Comply Details ** *** * must** be entered **in LITE** to reflect the specific reason for the **non-compliance that** caused the STEP sanction. **Reasons include failure to comply with:**

- Developing/signing an FSA,
- FSA Activities – Participation/Progress/Verification, or
- Refuse to accept employment – Quit – Terminate Reduced. **

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

There are no forms or instructions associated with this policy.

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IV. REFERENCES

[LAC 67](#):III.5717